Verses of Benediction

Toh 1107 · Derge Kangyur
ཤེས་པར་བར་རྫོ་པའ་ཚེགིས་ས་བྱ་ཙད་པ

The Verses of Benediction, in Tibetan Shipar Jöpé Tsiksu Chépa, is a short collection of auspicious verses that, as its closing lines state, is drawn from the chapter on the merchants Trapuṣa and Bhallika in the noble Lalitavistara Sūtra, the account of the Buddha's life known in English as The Play in Full. In that chapter the two merchants offer food to the newly awakened Buddha, and these verses form the blessing for their journey: they invoke the lunar mansions, the Four Great Kings and their sons, and the young goddesses, shrines, and mountains of each of the four directions, asking that the travelers be kept free from illness, gain wealth, and return home safely. No Sanskrit title is given at its head. It is preserved as Toh 1107 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the Dhāraṇī collection of protective and benedictory texts.

Verses of Benediction

Homage to the Three Jewels.

By the auspiciousness of the gods, which accomplishes aims
And brings auspiciousness to every quarter,
May your aims be accomplished,
And may all things swiftly turn in your favor.

As a garland rests upon the head,
May fortune be in your right hand;
May fortune dwell in your left hand too;
May fortune be in all your limbs.

May the merchants who, seeking wealth,
Travel in the ten directions,
Gain great profit,
And may they be happy and at ease.

When, for some purpose or other,
You travel to the east,
May the lunar mansions that dwell in that quarter
Protect you.

Kṛttikā and Rohiṇī,
Mṛgaśiras, Ārdrā, and Punarvasu,
And those called Puṣya and Āśleṣā:
These belong to the east.

These seven lunar mansions,
Renowned guardians of the world,
Are said to be in the eastern quarter.
May they guard you always.

Their lord and king
Is renowned as Dhṛtarāṣṭra;
He is the lord of all the gandharvas.
Together with the Sun may he protect you.

He has many sons,
Wise, and alike in name as well;
All ninety-one of them
Are called Indra, and they are mighty.
May they keep you free from illness,
And above all keep you in good fortune.

In the eastern quarter
There are eight young goddesses:
Jayā and Vijayā,
Siddhārthā and Aparājitā,
Nandottarā and Nandisenā,
Nandinī and Nandavardhanī.
May they keep you free from illness,
And above all keep you in good fortune.

In the eastern quarter
There is a shrine called Foundation Holder.
The Victors, the protectors, the arhats
Dwell there and know it.
May it too keep you free from illness,
And above all keep you in good fortune.

In that quarter may you fare well;
May no ill befall you.
Well protected by all the gods,
May you gain riches and return.

When, for some purpose or other,
You travel to the south,
May the lunar mansions that dwell in that quarter
Protect you.

Maghā, Pūrvaphalgunī, and Uttaraphalgunī,
Hasta, and Citrā, which is the fifth,
Svātī and Viśākhā:
These belong to the south.

These seven lunar mansions,
Renowned guardians of the world,
Are said to be in the southern quarter.
May they guard you always.

Their lord and king
Is said to be Virūḍhaka;
He is the lord of all the kumbhāṇḍas.
Together with Yama may he protect you.

He has many sons,
Wise, and alike in name as well;
All ninety-one of them
Are called Indra, and they are mighty.
May they keep you free from illness,
And above all keep you in good fortune.

In the southern quarter
There are eight young goddesses:
Śrīmatī and Yaśomatī,
Yaśaḥprāptā and Yaśodharā,
Sūtthitā and Suprathamā,
Suprabuddhā and Sukhāvahā.
May they keep you free from illness,
And above all keep you in good fortune.

In the southern quarter
There is a shrine called Padma,
Ever blazing with splendor,
Ever illuminating all things.
May it too keep you free from illness,

And above all keep you in good fortune.

In that quarter may you fare well;
May no ill befall you.
Well protected by all the gods,
May you gain riches and return.

When, for some purpose or other,
You travel to the west,
May the lunar mansions that dwell in that quarter
Protect you.

Anurādhā and Jyeṣṭhā,
Mūla, steadfast in diligence,
Pūrvāṣāḍhā, Uttarāṣāḍhā, and Abhijit,
And Śravaṇa, which is the seventh.

These seven lunar mansions,
Renowned guardians of the world,
Are said to be in the western quarter.
May they guard you always.

Their lord and king
Is known as Virūpākṣa;
He is the lord of all the nāgas.
Together with Varuṇa may he protect you.

He has many sons,
Wise, and alike in name as well;
All ninety-one of them
Are called Indra, and they are mighty.
May they keep you free from illness,
And above all keep you in good fortune.

In the western quarter
There are eight young goddesses:
Alambuṣā and Miśrakeśī,
Puṇḍarīkā and Aruṇā,
Ekānaṃśā and Navamikā,
The Playful One, Kṛṣṇā, and Draupadī.
May they keep you free from illness,

And above all keep you in good fortune.

In the western quarter
There is a mountain called Asta, the Setting,
Where both the sun and the moon set;
And the Setting too will bring you wealth.
May it too keep you free from illness,
And above all keep you in good fortune.

In that quarter may you fare well;
May no ill befall you.
Well protected by all the gods,
May you gain riches and return.

When, for some purpose or other,
You travel to the north,
May the lunar mansions that dwell in that quarter
Protect you.

Śatabhiṣaj and Dhaniṣṭhā,
Pūrvabhādrapadā and Uttarabhādrapadā,
Revatī and Aśvinī,
And Bharaṇī, which is the seventh.

These seven lunar mansions,
Renowned guardians of the world,
Are said to be in the northern quarter.
May they guard you always.

Their lord and king
Is Kubera, who rides upon a man,
The lord of all the yakṣas.
Together with Sudhana may he protect you.

He has many sons,
Wise, and alike in name as well;
All ninety-one of them
Are called Indra, and they are mighty.
May they keep you free from illness,
And above all keep you in good fortune.

In the northern quarter
There are eight young goddesses:
The goddess Ardor, the goddess Generosity,
Pṛthivī, and likewise Padmāvatī,
The Attendant of the Great King,
Āśā, Hrī, and Śrīmatī.
May they keep you free from illness,
And above all keep you in good fortune.

In the northern quarter
There is a mountain, Gandhamādana,
The abode of yakṣas and bhūtas,
Its many peaks lovely to behold.
May it too keep you free from illness,
And above all keep you in good fortune.

In that quarter may you fare well;
May no ill befall you.
Well protected by all the gods,
May you gain riches and return.

The twenty-eight lunar mansions
Dwell seven by seven in the four quarters;
The thirty-two daughters of the gods
Dwell eight by eight in the four quarters.

Eight śramaṇas and eight brahmins,
Eight market towns in the lands,
And the eight gods together with Indra:
May they guard you always.

When you set out, may it be auspicious;
When you return, may it be auspicious too.
May it be auspicious when you look upon your kin,
And auspicious too when your kin look upon you.

Through the loving care of the yakṣas and the Great Kings, with Indra,
And of the arhats,
May you everywhere obtain auspiciousness
And the blessed nectar of immortality.

Brahmā, and likewise Vāsuki,
The undefiled ones, the fully liberated,
The nāgas and the yakṣas: may they ever guard you with compassion,
And may your life be sustained a hundred autumns long.

This concludes the Verses of Benediction, which come from the chapter on the merchants Trapuṣa and Bhallika in the noble Lalitavistara Sūtra.

Translator's Notes

• These are the verses of benediction for the merchants Trapuṣa and Bhallika that also appear in the Lalitavistara; the Sanskrit forms of the goddess names follow that parallel where the Tibetan clearly reflects it. Among the eastern lunar mansions, nam so is read as nabs so, Punarvasu. In the western list, rna cha ("earring") is taken as Alambuṣā, cha med gcig ("the one without parts") as Ekānaṃśā, and stabs myur srid ("swift step") as Draupadī; rol ("play") could not be identified and is translated "the Playful One." As the text stands, this list gives nine names although eight goddesses are announced. In the northern list, rab chags lha mo and gtong lha mo could not be identified and are translated by meaning ("the goddess Ardor," "the goddess Generosity"), and rgyal po che la nyer gnas, "the Attendant of the Great King," is counted among the eight as the Tibetan has it. Kubera's companion, nor bzangs, is given its usual Sanskrit equivalent, Sudhana, but the figure is not securely identified. The name of the eastern shrine, gzhi 'dzin, is translated by meaning as "Foundation Holder."
• In the colophon, ga go na is read as ga gon, the usual Tibetan rendering of Trapuṣa. In the third verse, dbang bcas is taken, as in the first verse, as "together with Indra." The "nectar of immortality" (amṛta) wished for here is also an epithet of nirvāṇa, the deathless.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.